

design tool, and a click of a button can transfer the circuit to PCB Wizard. You need not worry about the layout as the wizard automatically takes care of placing the components on the board and routing your circuit.

In fact, this process looks like a mini movie when triggered. You can actually view the components being dragged into the board layout, moved around, and the routing and re-routing trials all happening live like series of animations. A text window on the bottom of the screen also tells you what exactly is being done, so as to keep you in the loop.

A little flexibility never hurts. This facility is made even more flexible by allowing you to choose from and use PCB Wizard's automatic tools to make your board the way you want. You could generate a circular board, specify

board size or add copper deposits in unused parts automatically, thus bringing down the net cost of your PCB.

Once the PCB is done, you can choose to add text on any layer, and the text is automatically mirrored at the base of the board. Style views come to the fore here, too, allowing you to view the PCB in different ways, like normal mode, real-world mode or prototype mode that shows where each component needs to be connected.

Weighing your design. Well, PCB designing is a costly process compared to simulating. It is only natural that you would want to know the costs involved beforehand. With Livewire, the process is simplified. You can produce a bill of materials spreadsheet containing properties assigned to the components in your design. You can define the exact format of the report,

total up the numeric properties for costings and so on. Let us leave you to find the rest of the offerings for yourself!

Livewire is built by New Wave Concepts, which also has other products that help design various aspects of electronic circuits. It comes in different packages, namely, standard edition, professional edition and educational edition. These differ in features provided and, of course, cost. Details of these can be found on Livewire's webpage www.new-wave-concepts.com/pr/livewire.htm. You can also find a support page that actively clarifies doubts and also appreciates suggestions for the software's betterment. **EFY**

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